Having worked with him over a period of time, I knew him extremely well and also knew that he had full faith in me. I could walk into his room any time after checking with his PS as to whether someone else was with him. But from his demeanour I could make out that Suntook didn't like my having confronted Trivedi with Sodhi.

I tried to visualize the real reason for Suntook's remarks. Did I inadvertently expose a R&AW source to the IB? It might have been so. Sodhi was not my source when I was posted at Ottawa, since the Department was not interested in Khalistan-related activities at the time. It's possible my successor had cultivated him in view of the changed requirements.

It is also possible that information relating to a threat to the prime minister could have come directly from London-based Jagjit Singh Chauahan through high level operational R&AW contacts established with him, to keep a tab on his organization's links with Pakistan and the ISI. Incidentally, despite Chauhan's best efforts, he had not succeeded in creating any noticeable following in North America for his cause until then.

In that context, the following excerpts from a report in *India Today'* s 28 February 1983 issue corroborate my views on the subject (Chapter 1): 'Until the spring and summer of 1981, the voice of pro-Khalistan elements was like a cry in the wilderness. Then came the sudden influx of more than 2,000 Sikhs seeking political asylum in Canada, claiming oppression and brutality at the hands of Mrs Gandhi's government.' [3]

Did the Indian government deliberately overlook such an exodus? Were Chauhan's men allowed to ferry so many Sikhs to Canada? At that time it was widely believed, both in Canada and Punjab, that most of the so-called seekers of political asylum (including a full Boeing 747 load which landed in Toronto) were directly or indirectly sponsored by Jagjit Singh Chauhan's set-up. There could not have been a more effective way of increasing the number of pro-Khalistan residents in Canada. To justify their claim of persecution by the Indian government for their political views, those asylum seekers had to necessarily get involved in pro-Khalistan activities.